

MEGATREND ANALYSIS

Capital rotates back into strategic capacity

Rising · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

The signal

M&A reopens, infrastructure fundraising rebounds, digital assets mature, and investment increasingly targets data, power, integration capability, and productive capacity.

\$206 billion

capital committed to infrastructure funds in 2025, described in the archive as a record year. ^[1]

\$3.4 trillion

IEA forecast for global energy investment in 2026, 5% above 2025. ^[2]

\$320 billion

stablecoin market capitalization at end-May 2026, according to the BIS. ^[3]

What is changing - and why it matters

Capital is returning, but not evenly. The archive points to renewed infrastructure fundraising, selective large-scale M&A, AI capacity, energy systems and digital-finance infrastructure. The common denominator is strategic capacity: assets that provide power, compute, data, distribution, integration capability or regulated access. Capital alone is insufficient because value increasingly depends on utilization, execution and active ownership. The winning investor is therefore the owner-operator able to transform an asset and navigate constraints, not merely the highest bidder.

Executive implication

The advantage moves to owners that can actively transform assets—not merely finance or acquire them.

Action agenda

- Define the scarce capabilities each investment must secure, not only the financial return or asset category.
- Build integration and operating playbooks before signing, including AI, talent, data, pricing and resilience levers.
- Stress-test returns against power availability, utilization, financing cost, regulation and slower adoption.

What could change the view

- Valuations assume utilization or adoption rates that the operating system cannot deliver.
- Capital concentration creates correlated exposure to the same power, semiconductor, data or regulatory bottleneck.

Selected evidence

[1] Weekly Brief · 2026-03-24 · Infrastructure Investing Is Back

- [2] Authoritative research · IEA · 2026-05-28 · **World Energy Investment 2026** · p. 6
- [3] Authoritative research · BIS · 2026-06-29 · **Anchoring Trust in Money: Innovation Beyond Stablecoins** · p. 12
- [4] Weekly Brief · 2026-08-04 · **Getting Real About Digital Assets**
- [5] Weekly Brief · 2024-12-04 · **Three Myths and One Truth About M&A**
- [6] Weekly Brief · 2026-05-27 · **How AI Changes Post-Merger Integration—and Beyond**
- [7] Weekly Brief · 2026-07-28 · **The AI Bill Lands on the CEO's Desk**
- [8] Weekly Brief · 2023-10-31 · **Is M&A About to Bounce Back?**
- [9] Authoritative research · IMF · 2026-07-08 · **World Economic Outlook Update: Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology**
- [10] Authoritative research · J.P. Morgan Global Research · 2026-07-01 · **Mid-Year Market Outlook 2026: The Tug of War Continues**
- [11] Authoritative research · BCG · 2026-05-18 · **The Future of Digital Assets**
- [12] Authoritative research · Goldman Sachs Global Institute · 2026-05-01 · **Tracking Trillions: The Assumptions Shaping the Scale of the AI Build-Out**
- [13] Authoritative research · Goldman Sachs Research · 2025-12-18 · **Why AI Companies May Invest More than \$500 Billion in 2026**

This independent analysis connects the available Weekly Brief archive with selected authoritative research. Forecasts and company-reported figures are identified in context. The complete evidence list remains available on the website.